CURRENT AFFAIRS

92. Consider the following pairs :

Regions sometimes mentioned in news		Country
1. Catalonia	–	Spain
2. Crimea	–	Hungary
3. Mindanao	–	Philippines
4. Oromia	–	Nigeria

Which of the pairs given above are correctly mateched ?

(a) 1, 2 and 3 (b) 3 and 4 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 2 and 4 only

Ans. (c) : Correct match is-
(1) Catalonia – Spain
(2) Crimea – Soviet Union (Ukraine)
(3) Mindanao – Philippines
(4) Oromia – Ethiopia
So, the correct answer is option (c)

93. Very recently, in which of the following countries have lakhs of people either suffered from severe famine/acute malnutrion or died due to starvation caused by war/ethnic conflicts?

(a) Angola and Zambia
(b) Morocco and Tunisia
(c) Venezuela and Colombia
(d) Yemen and South Sudan

Ans. (d) : The world faces one of the largest food crises in 70 years with 20 million people in four countries namely: Yemen, Nigeria, South Sudan and Somalia, according to FAO.

94. The term "two-state solution" is sometimes mentioned in the news in the context of the affairs of:

(a) China (b) Israel
(c) Iraq (d) Yemen

Ans. (b): Two-state Solution of Israel Palestine Issue: It envisages an independent state of Palestine alongside the state of Israel west of the Jordan River. The UNSC Resolution 1937 agreed in 2000 with support from the USA and becoming the first UNSC resolution to agree on two- state solution.

MISCELLANEOUS

95. "Rule of Law Index" is released by which of the following?

(a) Amnesty International
(b) International Court of Justice
(c) The Office of UN Commissioner for Human Rights
(d) World Justice Project

Ans. (d): The World Justice Project Rule Index measures rule of law adherence in 113 countries and jurisdictions based on more than 1,10,000 households and 3,000 expert surveys. Furthering primary data, the WJP Rule of Law Index measures countries rule of law performance across eight factors : constraints on Government Powers, Absence of Corruption, Open Government, Fundamental Rights Order and Security, Regulatory Enforcement, Civil Justice and Criminal Justice.

96. India enacted The Geographical Indications of Goods (Registration and Protection) Act, 1999 in order to comply with the obligations to:

(a) ILO (b) IMF
(c) UNCTAD (d) WTO

Ans. (d) : The Geographical Indications of Goods (Registration and Protection) Act, 1999, coupled with the Geographical Indications of Goods (Registration and Protection) Rules, 2002 which became operational with effect from 15 September 2003, was drafted as part of the exercise in the country to set in place national IPR laves as much in compliance with India's obligations under the Agreement on Trade Related Aspects of International Property Rights (TRIPS) of the 'Minimum' standards of GI protection that the TRIPS sets out for the WTO members to comply with in their respective national legislations.

97. Consider the following countries :

1. Australia 2. Canada
3. China 4. India
5. Japan 6. USA

Which of the above are among the 'free-trade partners' of ASEAN ?

(a) 1, 2, 4 and 5 (b) 3, 4, 5 and 6
(c) 1, 3, 4 and 5 (d) 2, 3, 4 and 6

Ans. (c): The Association of Southeast Asian Nations, or ASEAN, was established on 8 August, 1967 in Bangkok, Thailand, with the signing of the ASEAN Declaration (Bangkok Declaration) by the Founding fathers of ASEAN, namely Indonesia, Malaysia, Philippines, Singapore and Thailand.
ASEAN has existing free trade agreements with Australia, China, India, Japan, South Korea and New Zealand.

98. Consider the following pairs :

Towns sometimes mentioned in news	Country
1. Aleppo	Syria
2. Kirkuk	Yemen
3. Mosul	Palestine
4. Mazar-i-sharif	Afghanistan

Which of the pairs given above are correctly matched ?

(a) 1 and 2 (b) 1 and 4
(c) 2 and 3 (d) 3 and 4

Ans. (b) : Correct match is-
Aleppo – Syria
Kirkuk – Iraq
Mosul – Iraq
Mazar-i-sharif – Afghanistan

99. If a commodity is provided free to the public by the Government, then

(a) the opportunity cost is zero.
(b) the opportunity cost is ignored.
(c) the opportunity cost is transferred from the consumers of the product to the tax-paying public
(d) the opportunity cost is transferred from the consumers of the product to the Government.

Ans. (c) : Opportunity cost represents the benefits an individual investor or business misses out on when choosing one alternative over another.
When any have the opportunity to access public services for free, this would always come at the cost of somebody paying for it. In this case, the taxpayers bear the opportunity cost.

100. Consider the following pairs :

Craft		Heritage of
1. Puthukkuli shawls	–	Tamil Nadu
2. Sujni embroidery	–	Maharashtra
3. Uppada Jamdani saris	–	Karnataka

Which of the pairs given above is/are correct ?

(a) 1 only (b) 1 and 2
(c) 3 only (d) 2 and 3

Ans. (a) : Correct matches are–
Puthukkuli shawls – Tamil Nadu
Sujni embroidery – Bihar
Uppada Jamdani saris – Andhra Pradesh

UNION PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION

Civil Services (Preliminary Exam) - 2017

GENERAL STUDIES : PAPER-I

Time : 2 hours **(Exam date : 18.06.2017)** **Maximum Number : 200**

ANCIENT HISTORY

• Vedic Civilization

1. With reference to the difference between the culture of Rigvedic Aryans and Indus Valley people, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Rigvedic Aryans used the coat of mail and helmet in warfare whereas the people of Indus Valley Civilization did not leave any evidence of using them.
2. Rigvedic Aryans knew gold, silver and copper whereas Indus Valley people knew only copper and iron.
3. Rigvedic Aryans had domesticated the horse whereas there is no evidence of Indus Valley people having been aware of this animal.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 only
(b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans : (c) Statement (1) is correct- Rig-Vedic Aryans used the coat of mail and helmet in warfare, whereas the people of Indus Valley Civilization did not leave any evidence of using them.

Statement (2) is not correct- Various materials were used in Harappan Civilization to make beads, stones like carnelian jasper crystal, quartz and steatite, metals like copper, bronze and gold and shell artefacts and terracotta or burnt clay. Some beads were made of two or more stones cemented together, some of stone with gold caps.

Statement (3) is correct : Rigvedic Aryans had domesticated the horse whereas there is no evidence of indus valley people have been aware of this annimal.

• Buddhism, Jainism, Bhagavata and Shaiva Religion

2. With reference to the religious history of India, consider the following statements:

1. Sautrantika and Sammitiya were the sects of Jainism.
2. Sarvastivadin held that the constituents of phenomena were not wholly momentary, but existed forever in a latent form.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans : (b) Statement 1 is not correct:
Sautrantika and Sammitya were the sects of Buddhism.
Statement 2 is correct:
Sarvastivadins (they who say "All is real") had the view that the constituents of phenomena (dharma) were not wholly momentary but existed forever in a latent form.

3. The painting of Bodhisattva Padmapani is one of the most famous and oft–illustrated paintings at

(a) Ajanta (b) Badami
(c) Bagh (d) Ellora

Ans : (a) The painting is on the back wall of the interior hall before the shrine antechamber in cave no.1 at Ajanta, dating back to the late fifth century CE. The Boddhisattva is holding a Padma (lotus), has large shoulders and has their bents in the body, creating a movement in the picture space. The modelling is soft. The figure of the Boddhisattva is wearing a big crown in which detailed rendering is visible.

4. Which of the following is/are famous for Sun temples?

1. Arasavalli
2. Amarakantak
3. Omkareshwer

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

(a) 1 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans : (a) The famous Sun God Temple Situated in Arasavalli village, which is at a distance of about 1 km East of Srikakulam town district headquarters of the North coastal Andhra Pradesh. It is one of the ancient and all among two sun- god temples in our country. According to Padmapuranam, Sage Kasyapa installed the idol of Surya at Arasavalli for the welfare of mankind.